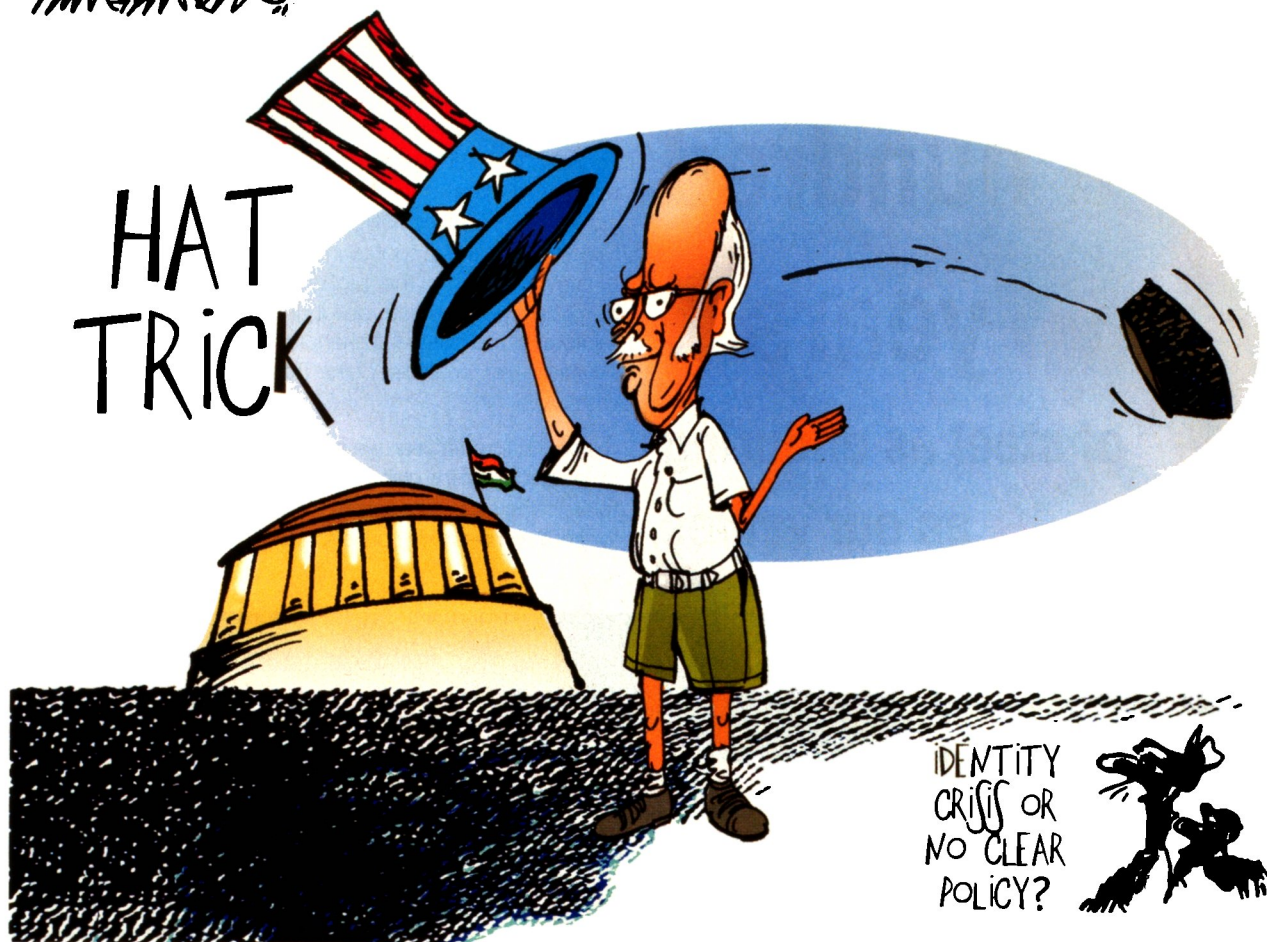


Ravi Shankar



THE BUZZ OF THE WEEK

If T.K.A. Nair, M.K. Narayanan, Shiv Shanker Menon and others (known as the "Mallu Mafia") feel their Onam plans were scuppered due to the UPA-Left tussle over 123, the blame should be laid on fellow Keralite Prakash Karat.

VOICES



"Soon, BSP will take over Delhi. After that the power will rest on us and the Congress leaders will realise the mistake of ignoring our demands."

Mayawati, Uttar Pradesh chief minister

"In a multi-party democracy, electability is a huge factor. Today, young leaders are thrown up only in two ways—either through caste or dynasty politics."

Arun Jaitley, BJP leader

"The Left is playing in the hands of China, which does not want the Indo-US nuke treaty to be inked as it will make India stronger, which will not be in the interest of China."

Buta Singh, former Union minister

"I admire J. Jayalalithaa for her determination and courage. She had to face a lot within her party and she had the courage to stand up. She has held the party together."

Kanimozhi Karunanidhi, DMK MP

"India must be the only democracy where neta after neta and babu after babu has been publicly exposed as corrupt but not one has been stripped of his ill-gotten crores."

Mallika Sarabhai, dancer

